

AWAKENARTS

A Map for What's Happening

The Four Movements of Symbolic Work

You don't need to do anything with this card except keep it nearby. It's a map, not an instruction sheet — most sessions move through these movements out of order, and more than once.

1 ENCOUNTER

Meeting the figure and the poem before deciding what either of them means. Looking, and reading, before explaining.

“What do you notice, before you explain it?”

2 RECOGNITION

The moment something in the figure touches something true in your own life — usually felt before it's named. A tightening, a tear, an unexpected laugh, a sudden stillness.

“Has anything here caught you off guard?”

3 REFLECTION

Putting language around what you've recognized — through conversation, journaling, or the prompts built into each Edition.

“What's a sentence that wants to come out of this?”

4 INTEGRATION

Letting what you've recognized actually change something — a choice, a relationship, how you see yourself — in its own time, not on a deadline.

“What might you carry out of this room?”

These movements aren't a staircase. You may circle back to encounter weeks later and notice something entirely new in the same figure. That's the model working as intended, not failing.

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Session Worksheet — Individual

For a one-on-one sitting (about 45–60 minutes)

Figure / Edition

Date

What did you notice, before anything else? (Observation)

What does this bring to mind — a memory, another image, a word? (Association)

What arises in your body or mood while looking? (Feeling)

What are you making of it, in your own words, right now? (Meaning)

In one sentence, where are you leaving this session?

Something small to carry forward with you:

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Session Worksheet – Group

For a group sitting (about 75–90 minutes, 4–10 people)

Figure / Edition

Date

One observation you shared aloud, before discussion began:

What else you noticed, beyond that:

Something said by someone else that stayed with you:

What you're making of this figure, in your own words:

In one sentence, where are you leaving this session?

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Session Worksheet — Return / Same Figure

For revisiting a figure you've sat with before

Figure / Edition

Date

Has anything from your last sitting with this figure stayed with you since?

What feels different about meeting it again, this time?

What's new, that wasn't here for you the first time?

In one sentence, where are you leaving this session?

Keep these worksheets together across a series — what looks unrelated session to session often isn't.